Dunama had plenty of non-Muslim subjects to enslave. On both his first and second pilgrimages to Mecca, the *Girgam* relates, he took three hundred slaves to sell in Cairo. He intended to do the same on his third pilgrimage, but drowned on his way across the Red Sea when his ship sank.[5] Kanem would not come fully into the fold of Islam until the reign of Salmama I at the end of the century, three generations later.

Farther to the east, the island nation of Kilwa was already thoroughly Muslim.

Like Kanem, Kilwa has a written royal chronicle. Around the tenth century, according to the *Kilwa Chronicle*, an Arab prince named Ali ibn al-Hassan was driven from his home in the prosperous city of Shiraz, just east of the Persian Gulf. He came to Kilwa with his six brothers and his father, sailing in seven ships. Swahili peoples lived on the island, and on the nearby coast; Ali bought Kilwa from them in exchange for cloth and settled there as the island's king, founding the Shirazi dynasty.[6]

It is impossible to know how much of this story actually dates from the early history of Kilwa, since the oldest surviving version of the *Chronicle* is a sixteenth-century Portuguese translation done by the explorer João de Barros. There is no proof that Ali ibn al-Hassan, whose coins still survive, came to the Swahili lands from the outside; like the details of the Kanem king list, the tale might be rooted in the Arab assumption that a civilized, organized Muslim kingdom could not have been founded by native Africans. And archaeological investigations suggest that Ali himself probably lived closer to the twelfth century than to the tenth. But ruins of mosques and prayer rooms do suggest that, by the tenth century, Arab merchants were not only trading with but also settling into the Swahili villages of Kilwa and the coast.[7]

Although the chronology of the Shirazi sultans is difficult to pin down, around 1150 Kilwa was probably ruled by Dawud b. Sulayman, who boasted the title "Master of the Trade." He controlled a kingdom that encompassed the islands of Pemba, Zanzibar, and Mafia, as well as Kilwa itself, and stretched to the coast of the mainland.[8]

This Kilwa empire flourished through trade. Song pottery along the coast testifies to sea trade with the southern dynasty of China; ivory from the south passed through Kilwa on its way north. Dawud b. Sulayman's greatest achievement was to negotiate a monopoly in the trading of gold through the city of Sofala. From the middle of the twelfth century on, merchants coming to the eastern coast of Africa for gold traded through Kilwa's increasingly wealthy port cities.[9]

IN THE WEST OF AFRICA other dynasties ruled over kingdoms and tribes that